

tomer feedback and both the sites make sure than if a seller has become a repeat offender, that seller will be barred from selling on their website. Don't let one bad egg ruin the entire basket for you.

We spoke to representatives from both eBay and Amazon, namely, Deepa Thomas – eCommerce evangelist for eBay, and Meenu Handa – Head of PR at Amazon India, and this is what they had to say.

Q) Are there any specific signs we can recommend from our end that users should definitely look out for in their online dealings with retailers?

eBay: Online shopping is completely secure as long as customers shop on a secure, reputed, shopping website. eBay has a robust feedback mechanism that enables buyers to rate sellers based on their experience with the seller. The feedback scores and the verbatim feedbacks are visible to all users. This helps buyers to take an informed decision about their purchase.

Amazon: "We are relentless in providing our customers a secure and reliable delivery experience. Towards that we encourage Customer Reviews on the product detail page and Seller Feedback Rating on the seller page. We believe these help customers make an informed buying decision. Customer Reviews provides unbiased feedback on the product from real shoppers while the Seller Feedback Rating provides feedback on seller performance. You will find that we keep both negative and positive reviews visible on the site. This has always been a tenet at the company ever since its inception."

Q) What sort of challenges do eCommerce face in procuring orders and ensuring their delivery? Do you play



Welcome to the dark side, we got digital shopping carts and high speed internet.



If you want to have this happy expression when shopping online, make sure you safeguard yourself against online fraud.

any role other than that of a "portal for sellers and buyers to connect?"

eBay: eBay is a pure marketplace and hence, is a platform to enable trade between sellers and buyers. We don't hold inventory and therefore the onus of shipping lies with the seller. There are more than 30,000 sellers on eBay India, spread across the country. The delivery time of the merchandise is majorly dependent on the geographical location of the buyer and the seller. Hence, deliveries within the same city / state would be faster than that compared to far away locations. So, the estimate time for a product to reach the buyer largely depends on the proximity factor.

To make the delivery system efficient and manageable for our sellers, we launched PowerShip, which is a logistics management service for eBay merchants which significantly enhance the efficiency of managing multiple item shipments and delivery of items to eBay India buyers. We've engaged with reputed logistic service providers like Bluedart, DTDC, Fedex & Aramax for this initiative. The service includes product pick-ups from eBay Merchants' doorstep, automated tracking of shipments, and faster item deliveries by Logistic Service

Providers and coverage for the shipment from eBay India.

Amazon: While it is difficult to generalize, but our delivery estimate is based on multiple factors such as shipping address location, courier coverage and speed of delivery to a particular region and seller location (in case of seller fulfilled orders). Order delays can be due to various reasons including external factors such as local holidays, customer availability at the given address, natural calamities, or social and political unrest or even weather.

Q) How do you deal with a transaction that goes bad?

eBay: At eBay India, it's our aim to provide consumers a pleasant, safe and transparent transaction. We have a secured payment mechanism called PaisaPay, which holds the money of the buyer till the transaction is fulfilled in accordance to the set policies. On making a sale, the seller is required to ship the product to the buyer within 5 days of the transaction and update the tracking number on eBay. If any seller fails to do so, the money is automatically refunded to the buyer. Moreover, the payment is released to a seller only once the product gets delivered to the buyer. This is India-specific innovation by eBay, keeping customer convenience in mind.

Amazon: If a customer contacts Amazon customer service because of a delay in delivery of an order which was Fulfilled by Amazon (FBA), we escalate it to our courier partners to rectify the problem and have the product delivered at the earliest. If the problem isn't resolved or there are long delays in a particular region due to uncontrollable factors which could be weather, natural calamities, or social & political disruptions we offer a refund to our customer. If the order is dispatched directly by the seller (only those using Selling on Amazon) we encourage our customers to contact the seller and allow them a chance to resolve the issue. However, all customer purchases for seller fulfilled orders are protected by Amazon's A-to-Z Guarantee, which ensures that the customer can get their money back in case the seller is unable to resolve their issue. 